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Toh 712 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 712 in the Kangyur is a short tantric dhāraṇī or mantra text concerned with the enhancement of memory and learning, known in Tibetan as beginning with an invocation to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara and presenting practical ritual instructions for memorization. The text does not carry a fully elaborated independent title of its own but belongs to a broader genre of dhāraṇī literature associated with Avalokiteśvara, the compassionate bodhisattva who is named in Sanskrit as Avalokiteśvara and in Tibetan as Sgyan ras gzigs. Its central concern is the transmission of mantras and accompanying ritual procedures — such as reciting over water before drinking it — said to enable a practitioner to memorize one hundred verses per day and, with sustained practice over six months, to become a master of all that one has heard. As Toh 712 in the Kangyur, it falls within the general class of dhāraṇī and mantra texts that populate the tantric and incantation sections of the Tibetan Buddhist canon, valued not for extended doctrinal exposition but for their efficacious ritual formulas and practical instructions.

If one recites this mantra and eats one meal each day, one will master one hundred verses per day. If one does this for six months, one will become a holder of what one has heard. The teaching on mastering one hundred verses is complete.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being endowed with great compassion, the noble Avalokiteśvara, lord of all he surveys.

Thus: khali khali bālīte svāhā.

When washing one's face, if one recites this mantra three or seven times over a cupped handful of water and drinks it, one will master one hundred verses in a single day. For those who have mastered texts previously,

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence with "For those who have mastered texts previously" — this appears to be a fragmentary passage, and the translation faithfully renders the incomplete final sentence. The mantra syllables "khali khali bālīte svāhā" are rendered in approximate transliteration as they appear; the Tibetan is itself a phonetic rendering of Sanskrit. The term

Colophon

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.